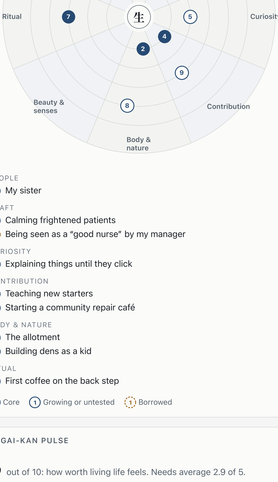
IKIGAI ATLAS · SEPTEMBER 21, 2026

Sam's ikigai

> **Life feels most worth living when I turn fear and chaos into understanding for the people around me, and when my hands are in soil or wood.**

SOURCES OF IKIGAI

9 sources across 6 of 8 areas. Nearer the centre means more worth.



PEOPLE
- 1 My sister

CRAFT
- 3 Calming frightened patients
- (6) Being seen as a "good nurse" by my manager

CURIOSITY
- 5 Explaining things until they click

CONTRIBUTION
- 4 Teaching new starters
- 9 Starting a community repair café

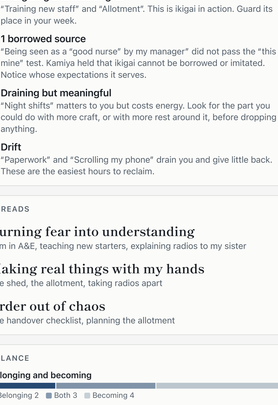
BODY & NATURE
- 2 The allotment
- 8 Building dens as a kid

RITUAL
- 7 First coffee on the back step

1 Core · 1 Growing or untested · (1) Borrowed

IKIGAI-KAN PULSE

6 out of 10: how worth living life feels. Needs average 2.9 of 5.



How fed each need feels · Sources feeding it (0 to 3+)

WHAT YOUR ATLAS SHOWS

- **Change & growth: hungry, even though you have sources**
 "Teaching new starters" and "Starting a community repair café" feed it, yet it sits at 2 out of 5. Ask whether they get enough of your time.
- **Freedom: hungry, even though you have sources**
 "The allotment" and "Building dens as a kid" feed it, yet it sits at 2 out of 5. Ask whether they get enough of your time.
- **Being myself: hungry, even though you have sources**
 "The allotment", "Explaining things until they click" and "Building dens as a kid" feed it, yet it sits at 2 out of 5. Ask whether they get enough of your time.
- **Well fed: Resonance and Meaning & value**
 Mostly through "My sister", "Calming frightened patients", "Explaining things until they click" and 3 more.
- **5 core sources**
 "My sister", "The allotment", "Calming frightened patients" and 2 more passed all three authenticity tests. Protect time for them first.
- **Energising and meaningful**
 "Training new staff" and "Allotment". This is ikigai in action. Guard its place in your week.
- **1 borrowed source**
 "Being seen as a "good nurse" by my manager" did not pass the "this is mine" test. Kamiya held that ikigai cannot be borrowed or imitated. Notice whose expectations it serves.
- **Draining but meaningful**
 "Night shifts" matters to you but costs energy. Look for the part you could do with more craft, or with more rest around it, before dropping anything.
- **Drift**
 "Paperwork" and "Scrolling my phone" drain you and give little back. These are the easiest hours to reclaim.

THREADS

Turning fear into understanding
3am in A&E, teaching new starters, explaining radios to my sister

Making real things with my hands
The shed, the allotment, taking radios apart

Order out of chaos
The handover checklist, planning the allotment

BALANCE

Belonging and becoming

Belonging 2 · Both 3 · Becoming 4

Where in time

Past 1 · Present 7 · Future 1

ENERGY MAP

drains you ← energy → fills you

SMALL JOYS

First coffee on the back step · Soil on my hands · A thank-you card from a patient · The radio while cooking · Rain on the shed roof · Explaining something and seeing it click

WORK LENS

Teaching and training All four circles	L G M P
Nursing care Comfortable, but may feel empty	L G M P
Carpentry and repair Passion	L G N P
A repair café Mission	L G N P

L love · G good at · N the world needs · P paid for

EXPERIMENTS AND RHYTHM

- ☐ **Block Sunday mornings for the allotment, phone off**
 This Sunday · feeds freedom · planned
- ☐ **Sign up for a beginner woodworking evening class**
 By Friday · feeds change & growth · planned
- ☐ **Ask the library about hosting one repair café morning**
 Next week · feeds a future to look toward · planned

EACH MORNING
What is one small thing today I am looking forward to?

EACH EVENING
Where did life feel worth living today?